



Pegged back by injuries: Australia's fast-bowling triumvirate of Josh Hazlewood, Mitchell Starc, and Pat Cummins are all expected to join the tournament late due to fitness concerns. PICS: K. MURALI KUMAR, SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP & SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

T20 World Cup, there are some injury concerns among bowlers, and that is a major headache for most teams. There is also the usual issue of some overseas players taking franchises for granted, as they are not going to be available for non-injury and personal reasons. The franchise owners go out of their way to accommodate their players, often paying for families to come and spend time with them at no cost to these millionaire players, mind you. It's the Indian way of hospitality, which is often misunderstood as a right by some, who then try to take advantage of the situation.

We are already hearing about some players

who will not be available for a variety of reasons, none of which were communicated before they were selected by the franchise.

Unless franchise owners start to get tough and drop these players, they will find themselves hampered in their efforts to win the title. All the planning that goes into forming a squad, they believe, can help them win, goes out of the window when players decide to come and go as they please.

Still, it promises to be a tournament that even the carpenter secretly keep a tab on, one where the evenings till May 31 will be unlike anything seen before.



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